Checkpoint #3: Adan

Role B. Catalog Admin · COSC 3380 · Group 6 · Due Tuesday, October 27, 2026

Your schedule

Week	What you do
Week 1 (Oct 8 to 14)	Help build the skeleton (Express layout, base page, navigation). Start the catalog list page.
Week 2 (Oct 15 to 21)	Add and edit item forms with the category row, copies (add, withdraw), publishers and authors forms. The items-and-copy-counts query.
Week 3 (Oct 22 to 26)	Merge Oct 22, test every page as staff, fix bugs only after the Oct 24 freeze.

What you build

You build the staff-only forms that keep the library's catalog up to date: items, their copies, publishers and authors.

Tables: CatalogItem, the category tables (Book, Videogame, BoardGame, DVD, Music, Newspaper, ResearchPaper), BookAuthor, PaperAuthor, Publisher, Author, Copy.

Build, in this order:

1. **Item list page.** Shows each item with its category, publisher and number of copies (a JOIN to Publisher, and a count of Copy rows).
2. **Add-item form.** The user picks a category, and the form shows that category's extra fields (an ISBN for a book, a platform for a videogame). Saving is two inserts that must succeed together: the CatalogItem row first, then the category row, with `Item_type` written explicitly in both. Use a transaction so one never saves without the other.
3. **Edit item.** Same fields, updating both rows.
4. **Copies.** Add a copy (unique barcode, condition, shelf location). "Withdraw" a copy by setting its `Status` to withdrawn, not by deleting it.
5. **Publishers and authors forms,** and a way to link authors to a book or research paper.

Query: items and their copy counts.

Watch out for: the database refuses a category row whose `Item_type` doesn't match the item, so show a friendly message instead of a raw error; the app must require a replacement cost, with historical newspapers between $150 and $425 and research papers between $174 and $425; a duplicate barcode or ISBN should say so plainly.

Done when: a staff user can add a book with two authors and two copies, edit it, and withdraw one copy, and the list page shows the right counts.

Key dates (all teams)

Date	What
Wed Oct 14	Skeleton live on Azure, login working
Wed Oct 21	Every area's pages merged and deployed
Sat Oct 24	Code freeze: bug fixes only
Mon Oct 26	Final test as each role, email sent to the TAs and uramamur@bcm.edu
Tue Oct 27	Checkpoint #3 deadline (safety day)

Working rules

- Stack: Node.js, Express, the mysql2 driver, plain HTML/CSS/JavaScript, MySQL.
- Test on your own local MySQL copy of the project dump, not on the hosted database.
- Keep database passwords out of GitHub. They go in a local `.env` file that is never committed.
- Merge into main at least every two days. One person owns each file.
- Deactivate or withdraw records instead of deleting them. History tables keep their rows.
- Stuck for more than an hour? Say so in the group chat.